REALITYCHECK AI

LIVE WEB EVIDENCE INVESTIGATION REPORT

TARGET QUERY:	Are electric vehicles cheaper to own than petrol cars?
DATE OF INVESTIGATION:	September 21, 2026 - 23:43 UTC
SOURCES ANALYZED:	3 Live Web Results (via SerpApi)
EVIDENCE CONFIDENCE:	**57%** - Multi-Factor Rating (57%): Evaluated across 4 weighted factors — 1) Source Volume (+15/30 pts: 3 sources) | 2) Claim Consensus (+8/30 pts: 1 supported vs 1 conflicting claims) | 3) Source Diversity (+15/20 pts: News, Official, Other) | 4) Directness & Recency (+20/20 pts: indexed search snippets). Note: Confidence reflects claim-level consensus and source credibility across 3 web sources (1 supporting, 2 conflicting), rather than a raw source count ratio.

1. Executive Summary

Based on live analysis of 3 web sources via SerpApi, the primary claim status is **CONFLICTING**. Evidence includes 1 supporting sources and 2 conflicting/counter-perspective sources.

2. Investigated Factual Claims

Claim 1: Factual core of question: 'Are electric vehicles cheaper to own than petrol cars' **[CONFLICTING]** (Confidence: Medium)

Analysis & Rationale: Multiple web sources were analyzed. 1 sources provide supporting context, while 2 sources highlight opposing views, criticisms, or qualifications.

Supporting Evidence:

- **U.S. Department of Energy** (Official): "Scheduled maintenance for an all-electric vehicle costs 40% less per mile than a conventional car."

Conflicting / Opposing Evidence:

- **Consumer Reports** (Other): "However, battery replacement after 8-10 years is expensive and a major financial drawback."
- **Reuters** (News): "Drivers save an average of $1,200 annually on electricity versus gasoline."

Claim 2: Key finding reported by U.S. Department of Energy: US DOE EV Cost Study... **[SUPPORTED]** (Confidence: High)

Analysis & Rationale: Source 'U.S. Department of Energy' (Official) states: "Scheduled maintenance for an all-electric vehicle costs 40% less per mile than a conventional car...."

Supporting Evidence:

- **U.S. Department of Energy** (Official): "Scheduled maintenance for an all-electric vehicle costs 40% less per mile than a conventional car."

3. Assessment & Limitations

Transparency Statement: RealityCheck AI retrieves real-time Google search results via SerpApi. Evidence confidence is evaluated dynamically based on source domain authority, inter-source consensus, and information directness. Automated analysis does not replace formal expert peer-review.

4. Analyzed Sources Appendix

Source	Category	Snippet / Evidence
U.S. Department of Energy	Official	Scheduled maintenance for an all-electric vehicle costs 40% less per mile than a conventional car....
Consumer Reports	Other	However, battery replacement after 8-10 years is expensive and a major financial drawback....
Reuters	News	Drivers save an average of $1,200 annually on electricity versus gasoline....